



Fleeing the battle

Thousands of civilians were forced to flee their homes and villages during April 1972 as North Vietnamese forces advanced through Quang Tri province. Many were killed by NVA bombardment of the routes along which they were fleeing.

Cloud descends

The skeleton group of US advisers sprang into action. Lieutenant Colonel George Turley, the deputy chief Marine adviser in South Vietnam, who was visiting Quang Tri sector, found himself thrust into the role of senior US adviser in the DMZ. B-52 bombers hit NVA staging areas at Khe Sanh and points outside the fighting zone. However, poor weather prevented fighter bombers from aiding South Vietnamese Marines under pressure in the west. It also hindered air support on the second day.

Surrender of Camp Carroll

By the evening of April 1, the western firebases had become untenable for the South Vietnamese and General Giai was forced to move his headquarters east to Quang Tri City. On April 2, Easter Sunday, the situation for the ARVN defenders in the west deteriorated further. Camp Carroll, the most important of the DMZ firebases, and the best equipped